STEPIN Offline Tournament

Business Customer Guide

> *This document is a guide for business customers new to STEPIN offline esports tournaments. It provides a comprehensive overview of the entire process, from tournament application to conclusion.*

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1. What is a STEPIN Offline Tournament?

STEPIN goes beyond an online tournament platform to support offline esports tournament operations. Business customers such as corporations, agencies, and brands (hereinafter referred to as "Organizers") host offline dance esports tournaments, where dancers from around the world compete in person at the venue.

Offline tournaments are operated by combining two STEPIN services:

Phase	Service	Description
Qualifier	STEPIN App	Recruit participants and run online qualifiers
Main Event	STEPIN Arcade	Real-time battles held at the offline venue

Participants (users) enter the qualifier via the app (STEPIN), while the main event is held at an offline venue with STEPIN Arcade installed. Organizers set up and manage the qualifier via the web (tournament.stepin.ai). The offline tournament can also be configured and operated from a single PC via a separate web interface that handles offline arcade tournament settings, bracket generation, and broadcast display.

> *This feature is an area that will be built together through consultation with WDSF.*

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2. Creating a Business Account

To host a STEPIN offline tournament, you must first apply for a business account in the STEPIN app.

How to Apply:

1. Access the STEPIN app → click the profile icon in the top-right corner → select Apply for Business Account.
2. Agree to the required terms.
3. Step 1. Enter your company information.
4. Step 2. Enter contact person information and submit.

Once your application is submitted, SIDEWALK will review it and notify you of the result. For corporations (companies, associations, foundations, educational institutions, organizations, etc.) and sole proprietors, additional documents may be requested for verification.

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3. Overall Tournament Process

From the Organizer's perspective, the tournament proceeds as follows:

Online Qualifier (STEPIN App) → Finals Participant Selection → Offline Main Event (STEPIN Arcade)

Phase	Service	Key Activities	Organizer Action
① Online Qualifier	STEPIN App	Recruit participants → Run qualifier → Select main event participants	Participant management (for private events: approve/reject — managed via web)
② Offline Main Event	STEPIN Arcade	Group Stage → Top 8 Double Elimination	On-site operation monitoring

> *Depending on settings, some stages may be omitted. E.g., the offline main event can be held without an online qualifier / the Top 8 Double Elimination can proceed without a Group Stage / Tournament formats can be modified upon WDSF request.*

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4. Step-by-Step Details

① Online Qualifier — STEPIN App

Prior to the offline main event, an online qualifier is held via the STEPIN app. Participants can enter from anywhere in the world, and main event participants are selected based on qualifier results.

For details on how the online qualifier operates, please refer to the STEPIN Online Tournament Guide.

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② Offline Main Event — STEPIN Arcade

What is STEPIN Arcade?

STEPIN Arcade is the dedicated client used at the offline tournament venue. It visualizes real-time battles between two players on a large screen, with AI automatically judging scores. Both players and spectators can enjoy a vibrant in-person tournament experience.

In addition to AI-based automatic scoring, human judging can also be incorporated.

> *Detailed criteria and operational methods for human judging will be reflected based on content provided by the WDSF.*

Default Tournament Format

The current format runs as: Group Stage → Top 8 Double Elimination.

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Group Stage  →  Top 8 Double Elimination
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> *The tournament format can be flexibly adjusted at any time based on the WDSFr's operational needs.*

Group Stage

The Group Stage is a preliminary phase where participants are divided into groups and compete in a full round-robin format before advancing to the main event. All participants within the same group compete against each other once, and those who advance are selected based on their performance.

Group Configuration by Number of Participants

Participants	Group Setup	Advancement Method
8	No Group Stage — proceed directly to Top 8	—
9–11	2 groups	Top 4 from each group advance (8 total)
12–15	4 groups	Top 2 from each group advance (8 total)
16	4 groups of 4	Top 2 from each group advance (8 total)

Group Stage Screen Layout

- The large screen displays participant lists per group and real-time match status.
- Matches proceed in order (MATCH 1, MATCH 2, etc.) and results are reflected immediately.
- Completed matches display win/loss results and set scores.

Tiebreaker Rules

If a tie occurs within a group, rankings are determined in the following order:

In case of a tie:

1. Head-to-head result
2. Total set differential
3. Total point differential
4. Single-game tiebreaker (if advancement is at stake)

Top 8 Double Elimination

The 8 players who advance from the Group Stage compete in a double elimination format to determine the final champion.

What is Double Elimination?

Unlike a standard tournament (single elimination), players are not immediately eliminated after one loss. Players who lose move to the Loser's Bracket and continue competing, and are only fully eliminated after a second loss.

Category	Description
Winner's Bracket	Main bracket where players proceed without a loss
Loser's Bracket	Bracket where players with one loss compete
Grand Final	Final match: Winner's Bracket 1st vs. Loser's Bracket 1st

Grand Final Special Rule

If the player coming from the Loser's Bracket defeats the Winner's Bracket player, the bracket resets and a final rematch is held. However, if the Winner's Bracket player wins the first Grand Final match, they are immediately declared the champion.

Match and Set Structure

Term	Description
Set	A single 1v1 dance battle between two players. The minimum unit that makes up a match.
Match	The competitive unit where the player who wins the required number of sets advances to the next stage.

Phase	Number of Sets	Description
General Rounds	Best of 7 (7 sets)	Player who wins 4 or more sets advances
Grand Final	Best of 9 (9 sets)	Player who wins 5 or more sets advances

All sets are performed consecutively without interruption. This is designed to evaluate both a player's stamina and consistency.

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5. Player Eligibility and Rules

Eligibility Requirements

Item	Details
Nationality	Must hold nationality of a participating country
Legal Status	Not eligible if convicted of a crime or under investigation
Minors	Consent from a parent or legal guardian is required
STEPIN Account	Must hold a valid account with no history of Terms of Service violations

Key Rules

Item	Details
Sportsmanship	Match-fixing, intentional losses, bug exploitation, etc. are prohibited
Disconnection	Unintentional disconnections are evaluated separately; intentional disconnections incur penalties
Accepting Rulings	Players must accept referee decisions; only official appeal procedures are permitted
Cheating	Even if discovered after the tournament ends, ranking disqualification and prize recovery are possible

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6. Tournament Format Customization

In addition to the default format, the tournament structure can be flexibly modified upon Organizer request.

Item	Default	Customizable
Main Event Scale	Top 8	Yes
Group Count & Setup	Automatically configured based on number of participants	Yes
Number of Sets	BO7 / Grand Final BO9	Yes
Team vs. Individual	Individual	Yes
Qualifier Format	STEPIN App Online Qualifier	Yes

For team events, the format (full round-robin or double elimination) is determined based on the number of participating teams, and specific configurations are decided through separate consultation with the Organizer.

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7. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q. Can we run the offline main event without an online qualifier?

Yes. If you do not set up an online qualifier, the Organizer can directly select the main event participants.

Q. Can the offline main event format be changed?

Yes. The default format is Group Stage → Top 8 Double Elimination, but the number of rounds, sets, and whether to use a team format can all be changed based on the number of participants and Organizer request. Please contact SIDEWALK separately.

Q. What is AI score judging?

STEPIN Arcade uses an AI system that recognizes players' movements and faces to automatically score performances. For this reason, outfits that cover the face or clothing that obstructs body tracking are prohibited.

Q. How are ties handled?

If a tie occurs in the Group Stage, rankings are determined in the following order: head-to-head result → set differential → point differential → single-game tiebreaker.

Q. How are prizes distributed to winners?

The winner results screen displays each winner's name, nationality, contact number, and email. The information can be downloaded as a CSV file. Cash prizes and goods are distributed directly by the Organizer.

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8. Contact & Support

For all inquiries related to STEPIN offline tournaments, please reach out through the channels below.

Website: tournament.stepin.ai

Email: cs@sidewalkplay.com

For tournament hosting applications, format changes, and winner-related inquiries, please contact us through the above channels.